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WAM

MOHAMMED LEADS FUNERAL PRAYERS FOR AHMED

■ His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, yesterday led mourners in performing funeral prayers for the late Sheikh Ahmed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum at Zabeel Grand Mosque in Dubai. Performing the funeral prayers alongside Sheikh Mohammed were Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE and Chairman of the Executive Council of Dubai, along with other dignitaries and officials.

SEE ALSO P7

377 fake Emiratisation cases in 266 firms detected

DUBAI

BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

The UAE has flagged 377 cases of fake Emiratisation involving 266 private-sector companies in the first half of 2026, the Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratisation (MoHRE) said yesterday.

The cases were uncovered through the ministry's field and digital monitoring systems, with legal action taken against the companies and other parties involved. MoHRE stressed that the violations were limited and did not constitute a widespread practice in the UAE labour market.

The ministry said action against offending companies was taken in accordance with Cabinet Decision No 43 of 2025 concerning administrative violations and penalties related to initiatives and programmes of the Emirati Talent Competitiveness Council.

Actual work

MoHRE said Emiratisation went beyond simply registering a UAE citizen as an employee of a private-sector company. It required a genuine and productive employment relationship involving actual duties and responsibilities, as well as opportunities for career development.

Fake Emiratisation, in contrast, involves registering Emiratis as employees to meet national employment targets without providing genuine jobs or actual work.

TRUMP TELLS UN HE FACES CHOICE OF IRAN DEAL OR DRIVING IT 'INTO HELL'

Post-midterm deal with Tehran still possible, he says

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump said yesterday he faced a stark choice between reaching a deal with Iran or "annihilating" the Islamic Republic, as he used his UN General Assembly address to defend the nearly seven-month war and intensify pressure on Tehran.

"Will a deal be made with Iran that lets them rebuild and create a far greater country than it ever was before, maybe one of the greatest in the Middle East or even the world?" Trump said.

"Or do I annihilate the Islamic Republic and do it quickly, never giving them a chance to kill and destroy people and countries again? Do I drive them into hell with no chance of survival?"

Agreement possible

Trump nevertheless said he believed an agreement was possible, predicting a deal could come after the US midterm elections in November.

"They're waiting to see how I do in the midterm election," he said, insisting the result would not affect his Iran policy.

Iran, however, said yesterday it had toughened its terms for ending the war, demanding the full release of \$24 billion in frozen assets before negotiations and adding an end to restrictions

DEEP CONCERN

UAE and seven nations issue joint Gaza warning

NEW YORK

The Ministers of Foreign Affairs of the UAE, Egypt, Qatar, Jordan, Indonesia, Pakistan, Turkey, and Saudi Arabia met in New York on Monday, on the margins of the 81st Session of the United Nations General Assembly.

The Ministers expressed deep concern over the continued humanitarian suffering in Gaza and called upon Israel to immediately fulfil its outstanding commitments under the First Phase of the Comprehensive Plan, including by ensuring the immediate, safe and unhindered delivery of humanitarian assistance and Early Recovery supplies, and facilitating the rehabilitation of critical infrastructure. They stressed the imperative of preserving the ceasefire and ending all violations.

The Ministers reiterated their categorical rejection of any measures aimed at the expulsion or the forced displacement of the Palestinian people from their homeland or attempts to alter the territorial or demographic character of the Occupied Palestinian Territory. The Ministers welcomed the recent measures taken by the United Kingdom, as well as broader national and European efforts, in response to illegal Israeli settlement activity, including measures to halt trade with illegal Israeli settlements and called for further effective measures to end settlement expansion and ensure accountability for settler violence. — WAM

on Houthi-controlled Yemen to its conditions.

"They broke the agreement and committed another vicious act. We have therefore toughened our conditions," Revolutionary Guards spokesman Hossein Mohebi told AFP.

In his UN address, Trump accused Tehran of stalling on an

agreement to fully reopen the Strait of Hormuz and negotiate an end to the conflict, which began in late February.

He also urged countries to join Washington in enforcing the "complete economic isolation of Iran" until Tehran stops attacks on commercial shipping, gives up its nuclear ambitions

EDGE geofenced UAE within 48 hours of Feb 28

CEO says years of preparation enabled systems to quickly reach shore borders

DUBAI

BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

EDGE Group deployed its systems along the UAE's shore border and geofenced the country within 48 hours of the February 28 escalation using its own equipment alongside systems from allies, Managing Director and CEO Hamad Al Marar told *Gulf News* in an exclusive interview.

"We, on the start of the conflict on February 28, within 48 hours, we were able to deploy all our systems on the shore border, and we geofenced the UAE with our equipment and with ally equipment," Al Marar said.

He said the deployment was possible because EDGE had been ready to move its systems and had anticipated the requirement. He added that this readiness came from a much longer period of preparation across the UAE.

"The reality is we prepare for this day every day," Al Marar said. "We are here to support

our armed forces logistically and supply personnel, whatever they might need."

Broader preparedness

He said the UAE's broader preparedness could not have been built in response to a single event. "This is not something you can prepare for overnight. It took decades," he said, describing February 28 as a testimony to the work of the Ministry of Defence, the country's leadership and others working in the sector.

The escalation has not changed EDGE's broader strategy, but it has accelerated the timetable for some capabilities.

"The only thing that changes in our strategy because of the conflict is acceleration," Al Marar said.

He said international technology partners could help EDGE deploy proven systems sooner, while the group continues to focus on upgrading and adapting solutions to evolving threats. Europe, South Korea, India and the US were among the partners he identified.

EDGE is also reassessing its defence systems, with plans to make them more robust, easier to use, more autonomous and capable of operating at greater range.

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NATION

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SPORT

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